

**State of Conservation Report on the Decisions of 45 COM 7B.14 the World Heritage
Committee on the Sundarbans World Heritage Site**



December, 2025



**Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
Government of the Peoples' Republic of Bangladesh**

1. Executive Summary of the report

Bangladesh, a South Asian country rich in biodiversity, is committed to preserving and conserving its natural resources. Although the country contributes very little to global carbon emissions, it is among the most climate-vulnerable nations in the world. Climate change poses significant risks to both the sustainability of conservation efforts in the Sundarbans and the country's broader sustainable development goals.

Despite facing climate-induced threats-such as sea-level rise leading to salinity intrusion in the Sundarbans, more frequent cyclones, droughts, and other extreme climatic events that place immense pressure on conservation initiatives-Bangladesh continues to invest substantial resources in protecting its environment, including the Sundarbans.

Bangladesh takes great pride in being home to the Sundarbans-the world's largest mangrove forest and in the UNESCO recognition of its three wildlife sanctuaries as World Heritage Sites in 1997. The forest covers approximately 6,017 sq. km within Bangladesh and is renowned as a global biodiversity hotspot, supporting 270 species of birds, 35 species of reptiles, and 42 species of mammals. It also provides critical habitat for threatened and endangered species such as the estuarine crocodile, Indian python, and Bengal tiger.

According to the Draft National Forest Inventory (NFI) report 2024, the Sundarbans carbon stock increased from 139 million tons in 2019 to 143.80 million tons in 2024. The forest experienced almost no loss of cover between 2001 and 2025, and the long-standing moratorium on tree felling has been extended to 2030.

In 2017, the extent of Protected Areas was expanded to 53.52% of the Sundarbans, up from the previous 23%. To safeguard forest resources and strengthen law enforcement, SMART (Spatial Monitoring and Reporting Tools) and drone-assisted patrols have been deployed since 2015. Six Dolphin Wildlife Sanctuaries have also been declared within and around the Sundarbans to conserve the Ganges River Dolphin and Irrawaddy Dolphin.

To protect breeding habitats for wildlife and fish and to ensure sustainable resource use, the State Party has enforced an annual three-month ban on the collection of all forest products and on tourism activities since 2020. The State Party has also initiated ecological monitoring and the development of a revised Integrated Resources Management Plan (IRMP).

Furthermore, local communities are actively involved in the management and conservation of the Sundarbans, supported by a range of initiatives that promote alternative livelihoods and enhance their socio-economic well-being.

The conservation of the Sundarbans remains one of the State Party's highest priorities—not only because of its exceptional natural beauty, but also due to its vital role as a natural resource base and as a protective barrier against natural disasters. As a densely populated country with limited land area, Bangladesh must pursue development in tandem with the preservation of global and national heritage assets such as the Sundarbans.

The State Party reaffirms its strong commitment to safeguarding the Outstanding Universal Value (OUV) of the property while implementing forward-looking development plans for the region in the decades ahead. The diverse interventions undertaken clearly reflect this dedication and demonstrate the extent to which the State Party is prepared to integrate nature conservation into its national development agenda.

2. Response to the Decision of the World Heritage Committee (Decision: 45COM 7B.14)

2.1. Decision no. 2

Recalling Decisions 38 COM 78.64, 41 COM 78.25, 43 COM 78.3 and 44 COM 78.91 adopted at its 38th (Doha, 2014), 41st (Kraków, 2017), 43rd (Baku, 2019) and extended 44th (Fuzhou/online, 2021) sessions respectively,

Response

A comprehensive response on the decisions 41 COM 7B.25, 43 COM 7B.3 and 44 COM 7B.91 has already been sent to the WHC on 29.11.2018, 30.01.2020 and 30.01.2022 respectively.

2.2 Decision no. 3

Welcomes the State Party's continued efforts towards enhancing the protection of the property and the progress in implementing the recommendations of the 2019 joint World Heritage Centre/IUCN Reactive Monitoring mission, undertaking effective conservation measures through planned forestation and requests to continue to implement the mission recommendations as agreed by the State Party and previous Committee decisions,

Response

The state party remains fully committed to sustaining and strengthening effective conservation measures, including planned forestation initiative and reaffirms its dedication to carrying forward all mission recommendations and previous committee decisions as agreed.

2.3 Decision no. 4

Appreciates the national measures taken by the State Party on the Maitree Super Thermal Power Plant (MSTP) to avoid impacts on the Outstanding Universal Value (OUV), in accordance with the Environmental Management Plan, and further appreciates the decision of the State Party to revise the Power System Master Plan (PSMP) to replace the second unit of the MSTP with solar PV power plant and subsequent cancellation of six other coal-fired power plants as part of Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC);

Response

The state party acknowledges the appreciation and will continue the effort. The feasibility study for block B (replacement of coal unit) of the Maitree Super Thermal Power Plant (MSTP), with a proposed capacity of 442 MW has already been completed. The findings of the study are currently under government review to ensure full alignment with the Integrated Power and Energy Master Plan 2023

(IPEMP 2023), the Nationality Determined Contribution (NDC) and the national priority of safeguarding the Outstanding Universal Value (OUV) of the surrounding area. Subsequent policy decisions regarding the future of block B will be based on the feasibility study's recommendations, taking into consideration environment safeguards, system planning requirements and the government strategic direction towards cleaner and more sustainable energy development.

2.4 Decision no. 5

Notes with appreciation the completion of the Strategic Environmental Assessment (SEA) and the Strategic Environmental Management Plan (SEMP) for the South-West region of Bangladesh in 2021 and submission to the World Heritage Centre in 2023, and further notes the findings of the SEA that the scale of potential degradation of the OUV of the property through proposed development scenarios remains unknown, and also requests the State Party to

- a) continue to implement the SEMP in order to avoid direct, indirect and cumulative impacts from developments in the South-West region over the next twenty years that are identified in the SEA,*

Response

The State Party appreciates this guidance and reaffirms its strong commitment to the continued implementation of the Strategic Environmental Management Plan (SEMP). We fully recognize the importance of addressing the direct, indirect, and cumulative impacts of development in the South-West region over the coming decades, as identified in the Strategic Environmental Assessment (SEA). The State Party will continue to apply the SEMP as a key instrument to ensure sustainable development, safeguard ecological integrity, and uphold its obligations to protect the Outstanding Universal Value of the property.

The Government of Bangladesh has promulgated the Environment Conservation Rules (ECR) 2023, replacing the ECR 1997. It has also, for the first time, introduced the Air Pollution Control Rules 2022 and updated the Noise Pollution (Control) Rules 2025. Industries in the south-west region are now monitored in accordance with these updated regulations.

- b) submit the additional studies and data-gathering framework outlined in chapter 4.8 of the SEMP to the World Heritage Centre for review as soon as they are completed,*

Response

The State Party acknowledges this request and confirms its commitment to completing the additional studies and data-gathering framework outlined in Chapter 4.8 of the SEMP. Upon completion, all relevant materials will be promptly submitted to the World Heritage Centre for review, in line with established procedures and our continued efforts to strengthen evidence-based management of the property.

- c. Ensure that decision making regarding large- scale industrial development in the vicinity of the property is based on the provisions of the Guidance and Toolkit for Impact Assessments in a World Heritage Context in order to ensure the long- term protection of the OUV.*

Response

Since 2017, no Environment Clearance Certificates have been issued for large-scale industries in the Sundarbans Ecologically Critical Area (ECA), Which includes Khulna, Bagerhat and Satkhira.

d. Keep the World Heritage Centre informed of any major project that may impact the OUV in conformity with Paragraph 172 of the Operational Guidelines.

Response

The World Heritage Centre Will be updated regarding any major projects that might influence the established Outstanding Universal value (OUV of the Sundarban ECA.

2.5 Decision no. 6

Appreciates the state Party for adopting the National Oil and Chemical Spill Contingency Plan (NOSCOP) 2020 during the difficult times of COVID-19, and further appreciates the state party for implementing NOSCOP and developing Localized Contingency Plan to mitigate the possible impact in case of emergency;

Response

National Oil and Chemical Spill Contingency Plan (NOSCOP) 2020 has been developed and now implementing successfully. Localized Contingency Plan to Mitigate the possible impact in case of emergency has been developed which is under process of approval in the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC).

2.6 Decision no. 7

Noting that the India-Bangladesh Joint Working group and the India-Bangladesh Joint River Commission are important bilateral mechanisms to address transnational matters, reiterates its request to the State Parties of Bangladesh and India to strengthen cooperative action for the eco- hydrology of the property and the adjoining Sundarbans National Park in India:

Response

Under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC), Bangladesh and India coordinate on the transboundary management of the Sundarbans through a 2011 MoU on Sundarbans Conservation and a Protocol on Tiger Conservation, which established a Joint Working Group (JWG).

The 2nd JWG meeting, planned for January 29–30, 2024, was postponed due to unavoidable circumstances, with a new date to be set later. Despite irregular meetings, both countries maintain active collaboration through bilateral visits, seminars, workshops, and knowledge-sharing initiatives for Sundarbans and tiger conservation.

The SUNDAR-BAY Project funded by German Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development (BMZ) and implemented jointly by GIZ and Bangladesh Forest Department further

enhances Bangladesh– India cooperation for the sustainable management and restoration of the Sundarbans and adjacent coastal ecosystems. In partnership with the Wildlife Institute of India (WII), the project promotes joint monitoring of key species, development of a shared transboundary map, and capacity building through exchange visits and gender-responsive training for forestry officials. It also supports community-based livelihood training, establishment of a Sundarbans Knowledge Forum, and youth engagement through the Earth Scouts and Earth Mentors programs.

By integrating gender inclusion, sustainable financing and knowledge exchange, these joint initiatives aim to strengthen transboundary cooperation and ensure the long-term conservation and resilience of the Sundarbans ecosystem.

According to the Ganges Water Sharing Treaty of 1996, the India-Bangladesh Joint Rivers Commission (JRC) has been working to ensure an equitable distribution of water flow in the Ganges River system between the two countries. However, the existing treaty does not include any provision for cooperation regarding the eco-hydrology of the property and the adjoining Sundarbans National Park in India. As the treaty is set to expire in 2026, initiatives for its renewal are currently underway.

2.7 Decision no. 8

Acknowledges that continued sustainable development is a shared responsibility for all, and the State Party has the obligation to implement the relevant targets of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and therefore requests the state Party to use the SEMP as a basis for deciding on the large development projects and take adequate national measures to protect the OUV of the property;

Response

It is the sincere commitment of the State Party to uphold the Outstanding Universal Value (OUV) of the Property. In alignment with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), the SEMP document has been shared with the Planning Commission for their consideration in the planning and implementation of major development projects in the south-west region of Bangladesh. Furthermore, the draft office order for the establishment of the SEMP Advisory Committee (SAC) and the SEMP Coordination Unit (SCU) has been forwarded to the MoEFCC for approval.

The updated information on the substantial efforts to enhance the protection of the OUV through the implementation of various conservation measures are mentioned below:

2.7.1 Moratorium on logging for conservation of floral species

Previously commercial logging was permitted in the Sundarbans. For the protection and conservation of the Sundarbans, the government imposed a moratorium on logging in the natural forest, including the Sundarbans, from 1989 until 2022. The moratorium has been extended up to 2030. It depicts that the Government does not treat the Sundarbans as a source of revenue income as before but wants to conserve it. Due to this moratorium, the trend of stealing Sundarbans tree species has completely stopped as they are no longer being sold or used outside.

2.7.2 Expansion of Protected Areas:

In 1996, 3(three) wildlife sanctuaries (Sundarban East, West and South) were declared with an area of about 1,39,699.49 hectares for biodiversity conservation and maintain undisturbed breeding ground for wildlife which are also the World Heritage Site (WHS). The area of these 3(three) Protected Areas has been increased to 3,17,950.08 ha in 2017. Now, the total area of Protected Areas covers about 53.52% area of the Sundarbans. Collection/extraction or harvesting of all kinds of resources is strictly prohibited from the Protected Areas.

2.7.3 Spatial Monitoring and Reporting Tools (SMART) Patrolling in the Sundarbans:

SMART (Spatial Monitoring & Reporting Tools) based monitoring system is being implemented in the Sundarbans since 2015. This monitoring system has become very much helpful to monitor and protect the resources of the Sundarbans. A total of 3747 suspects were arrested from January 2018 to October 2025. During patrols, 2257 watercrafts, 2459 fish and crab traps, 395 tree cutting tools were seized, and 99 cases of fishing with poison were recorded. Drone based monitoring system has also been adopted in the SMART patrolling. During this period, 48,530 terrestrial mammals, 11,770 aquatic mammals, 6,128 reptiles and 21,439 birds were observed. 23 different types of wildlife were observed during SMART patrolling in the Sundarbans.

2.7.4 Initiatives for Dolphin Conservation

Waterways of the Sundarbans mangrove forest, supports the Vulnerable Ganges River dolphin (*Platanista gangetica*) and Near Threatened Irrawaddy dolphin (*Orcaella brevirostris*). For effective conservation and management, based on scientific study and survey 6(six) dolphin sanctuaries (Dhangmari, Chandpai, Dudhmukhi, Shibsha, Bhodra and Pankhali) covering 4497.0 hectares have been established in and adjacent areas of the Sundarbans. 70 Members are working under 7(seven) Dolphin Conservation Teams (DCT) in the field along with Bangladesh Forest Department staff and Co-Management Committee to aware local people about Dolphin conservation, rescue the stuck dolphins, and monitor the dolphins.



2.7.5 Initiatives to mitigate Human-Wildlife Conflict through compensation

To resolve the issue of Human-Wildlife Conflict, the Government enacted Wildlife Victims Compensation Rules in 2021. According to these rules in case of death of a person attacked by a wildlife the victim's family will get compensation of BDT 3,00,000 and in case of serious injury BDT 1,00,000, which was earlier BDT 1,00,000 and BDT 50,000 respectively. So far, compensation has been provided to 27 people injured in tiger attacks and the families of 75 people killed, while compensation has been provided to 3 people injured in crocodile attacks and the families of 5 people killed.

2.7.6 Initiatives for rewarding the informer about the wildlife' poachers/smugglers

The Bangladesh Government enacted Rules declaring reward package for the informers on Wildlife crimes in 2020. According to these rules, if anyone provides any crime information related to poaching, hunting, trapping, smuggling or other crime, the informer will be rewarded. This helps to prevent wildlife crimes in Sundarbans. So far, a total of BDT 5,25,000 has been rewarded to 52 informants for providing information related to wildlife crimes, as per the rules.

2.7.7 Initiatives for Tiger Conservation

- Second generation Bangladesh Tiger Action Plan (2018-27) has been approved by the Government. The first generation BTAP was for the period 2009-2017. It provides a vision, goals and objectives to guide an integrated and focused tiger conservation program.
- National Tiger Recovery Program (2017-22) was developed and which is currently under process of updating for the period 2023 to 2034.
- The results of the tiger census, conducted through camera trapping, were announced in 2024. The number of tigers in the Sundarbans has been found 125, which was 114 in the last census in 2018.
- Research on Parasitic infection and other communicable diseases, with their causal agents and extent in Sundarbans tigers is ongoing under Sundarbans Tiger Conservation Project (STCP). This study will also help in the conservation of tiger and its habitat, i.e. the Sundarbans.
- To reduce the human-tiger conflict, 49 Village Tiger Response Teams (VTRT) consisting of 340 members involving local community and 1 Forest Tiger Response Team (FTRT) have been formed. To prevent tigers from entering the locality, 45 km long nylon fence adjacent to the locality of the Sundarbans has been constructed, and 29 km more is under construction.
- In addition to regular patrolling by boat, foot patrolling is carried out in coordination with CMC, VTRT and Forest Department. Monthly yard meetings with women in the community are held regularly for awareness.
- 178 CPG members are being paid a vigilance allowance of BDT 5,000 per month under the Protection of Sundarban Mangrove Forest Project.
- 12 killas (high land) have been built and 8 more are under construction to provide shelter for tigers and other wildlife from various natural disasters like cyclone and tidal surge.
- 12 pond Excavation and 84 ponds re- excavation has been done in order to supply fresh water for tiger, wildlife and forest resource collectors.

2.7.8 Wildlife Rescue and Breeding Centre

A Wildlife rescue and breeding center has been established in 2000 at Karamjal mainly for crocodile, deer and turtle. At this breeding center, artificial breeding, rearing, and later release of saltwater crocodiles into the wild are being conducted. Currently, there are 92 crocodiles in the Wildlife Breeding Center in Karamjal, of which 2 adult male and 2 adult female crocodiles. Under successful breeding program, a total of 216 crocodiles have been released into various rivers and canals of the Sundarbans. Another breeding center has been established in Karamjal for the long-term conservation of the critically endangered Batagur baska (Northern River Terrapin). The facility currently houses 462 individuals (16 adult and 446 Juveniles). To better understand their ecology, 20 Batagur baska were released into the wild with satellite transmitters in 2019, 2020 & 2022 to study their movement patterns. Since 2022, a total of 134 individuals have been released into 16 ponds within the Sundarbans as part of a soft-release program aimed at supporting their gradual adaptation and survival in natural habitats.

2.7.9 Periodical banning of all types of Forest products and control tourism

- In order to conserve and maintain an undisturbed breeding ground for wildlife, from the year 2020 the Government has prohibited collection of all sorts of forest products including fishes, crabs, honey etc. and tourism activities for the period of three months (June, July & August) yearly.
- To conserve the fisheries resources of the Sundarbans, restrictions have been imposed on fishing time, 18 limited canals, nets, size and weight of fish.
- To reduce tourism pressure on protected areas, 4 new eco-tourism sites have been developed outside the protected areas.
- To protect the biodiversity of the Sundarbans, the government has permanently stopped holding fairs at places of worship on Ras Purnima from 2021 and only devotees are allowed to perform worship.

2.7.10 Involvement of Local Community through Co- Management approach

To ensure greater participation and sharing of benefits derived from natural resources, extensive local community involvement in co-management activities in the Sundarbans was initiated in 2009-10. Four (4) Co-Management General Committees and four (4) Co-Management Executive Committees have been formed. In addition, 211 Village Conservation Forums (VCF), Four (4) Public Forums (FP), 22 Community Patrolling Groups (CPG) are functioning. The co-management activities are regulated by the Protected Areas Co-management Rules, 2017. Sundarbans West Forest Division, Khulna has earlier provided BDT 17,87,000 to Satkhira Co-management Committee and Dakop-Koira Co-management Committee in the financial year 2023-24 and BDT 29,00,000 in the financial year 2024-25. BDT 29,00,000 will be provided in the financial year 2025-26. Under co-management approach, various alternative income generation (AIG) supports have been provided to the local community to reduce pressure on the Sundarbans.

2.7.11 Ecological Monitoring of the Sundarbans

Ecological monitoring activities are being conducted in accordance with the approved Methodological Framework of Ecological Monitoring of the Sundarbans. Expert teams are systematically carrying out field surveys to gather data on both biotic and abiotic indicators, encompassing vegetation, wildlife, as well as air, soil, and water parameters. The primary objective of this monitoring is to establish a comprehensive baseline dataset reflecting the ecological status of the Sundarbans and to develop an Integrated Ecological Monitoring System for long-term, periodic assessment to inform management and conservation actions. The assignment is progressing according to schedule and is anticipated to be completed by mid-2026.

2.7.12 Assessment of Aquatic Resources of the Sundarbans

The Draft Assessment of Aquatic Resources of the Sundarbans has been prepared in October 2025 as part of the Protection of Sundarbans Mangrove Forests Project (PSMFP). This report provides detailed reports on aquatic resource management, fish biodiversity monitoring, shellfish (mollusks and crustacean) biodiversity, fisheries stock assessment, DNA taxonomy analysis, non-piscine aquatic species, mangrove ecology study, climate change and fisheries management practices and provides recommendations for their management.

2.7.13 National Forest Inventory

Bangladesh Forest Department (BFD) is implementing bio-physical and socio-economic survey under the National Forest Inventory including Sundarbans. The analysis of these data will provide update information on the tree resource of Sundarbans as well as the degree of dependency of local community on forest resources by December 2025.

2.7.14 Sustainable Development Goal (SDG)

Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 6, Which aims to “ensure availability and sustainable management of water and sanitation for all,” highlights the critical importance of integrated water resources management (IWRM). Bangladesh Water Development Board (BWDB) is playing important role in bridging development and environmental sustainability by aligning its activities with SDGs, focusing on eco-sensitive projects, conducting environmental impact assessments, and fostering community partnerships.

BWDB conducts Feasibility Study and Environmental & Social Impact Assessment (ESIA) for all major projects. BWDB will consider the recommendations of Strategic Environmental Assessment (SEA) and Strategic Environmental Management Plan (SEMP) for the South-West region conducted by Forest Department in 2021 (www.seasw-sundarbansbd.org.)

In addition, World Heritage conservation for the Sundarbans as well as for other natural forests may be followed/ensured according to the guideline by UNESCO and the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) to emphasize co-management with local communities, systematic ecological monitoring and robust management plans and conduct reactive monitoring to protect its outstanding universal as well as local value.

2.7.15 Environmental Cooperation and Management

MPA continues to work under the framework of the Strategic Environmental Management Plan (SEMP) Bangladesh, a national initiative designed to address environmental challenges, conserve natural resources, and promote sustainable development in and around the Sundarbans region. MPA's environmental actions are aligned with the recommendations of the World Heritage Committee, ensuring integrated management and environmentally responsible port operations.

2.7.16 Jurisdiction and Coordination

The establishment or control of large-scale industrial development in the region lies outside MPA's jurisdiction. Nevertheless, any future port-related initiatives will be undertaken in close cooperation with the National SEMP and relevant government agencies to ensure full compliance with UNESCO's conservation standards and to avoid any adverse impact on the Outstanding Universal Value (OUV) of the property.

2.7.17 No Adverse Constructions or Activities

MPA confirms that it has not undertaken any major restorations, dredging, or construction projects that could affect the OUV, authenticity, or integrity of the Sundarbans. Port maintenance activities are carefully monitored under national environmental laws and international best practices.

2.7.18 Current Status

The Sundarbans (Bangladesh) is not inscribed on the List of World Heritage in Danger. MPA acknowledges and supports national efforts to maintain this status through continuous monitoring, compliance and cooperation with UNESCO and IUCN guidelines.

Mongla Port Authority reaffirms its strong commitment to ensuring that all port operations and developmental activities are consistent with UNESCO World Heritage conservation principles. MPA maintains close coordination with the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC), the Department of Environment (DoE), and National SEMP Bangladesh to support the long-term protection and sustainable management of the Sundarbans World Heritage property.

Payra Port strictly adheres to the guidelines and compliance requirements of the Strategic Environmental Assessment (SEA) and the Strategic Environmental Management Plan (SEMP) for the South-West region of Bangladesh. Furthermore, afforestation programs are being implemented across designated areas of Payra Port. This tree plantation program is designed as a continuous and long-term environmental stewardship effort. It contributes to carbon absorption, biodiversity enhancement, and overall ecological balance. The port authority views afforestation as a vital part of sustainable port management practices.

Payra Port also integrates environmental conservation into its planning and operational frameworks. It strictly adheres to the compliance requirements of the Strategic Environmental Assessment (SEA). Additionally, it follows the Strategic Environmental Management Plan (SEMP) set for the South-West region of Bangladesh.

2.8 Decision no. 9

Takes note of the ongoing preparation of the new 2025-2035 Integrated Resource Management Plan (IRMP) for the Sundarbans and requests furthermore the State Party to continue consultations with the communities;

Response

The Draft Integrated Resources Management Plan (IRMP) for the Sundarbans 2025–2035 was submitted to the Bangladesh Forest Department (BFD) in October 2025 as part of the Protection of Sundarbans Mangrove Forests Project (PSMFP). This report incorporates comprehensive inputs, suggestions, and recommendations from forest-dependent livelihood groups, local government representatives, Co-management Committees, academicians, and BFD officials.

The draft outlines 13 distinct management programs, each featuring detailed prescriptions and strategic actions designed to facilitate the sustainable management of the Sundarbans Reserved Forest (SRF).

Following submission, the BFD thoroughly reviewed the draft and provided comments and recommendations. These are presently being addressed by the Expert Team. The finalized IRMP 2025–2035 is scheduled for completion by December 2025, pending outcomes of the national validation workshop.

3. Other current conservation issues identified by the State(s) Party(ies) which may have an impact on the property's Outstanding Universal Value

At present, no significant conservation issues have been identified. However, several research initiatives are currently underway, including ecological monitoring; the Assessment of Aquatic Resources of the Sundarbans; the updating of the IRMP; studies on parasitic infections and other communicable diseases affecting tigers; and the Monitoring of 27 Crime-Prone Hotspots for Tiger and Deer Poaching in the Sundarbans through Camera Trapping. These activities are being conducted under the Sundarban Protection Project and the Tiger Conservation Project, and their findings will be finalized soon.

Should any major conservation concern emerge from these studies-particularly one that could affect the Outstanding Universal Value (OUV) of the property-the State Party will promptly inform the World Heritage Centre.

No conservation Issues have been identified by MPA that could directly or indirectly affect the property's OUV. All port operations and navigational activities are being managed to prevent environmental degradation pollution or disruption to the natural and ecological balance of the Sundarbans area.

4. In conformity with Paragraph 172 of the Operational Guidelines, describe any potential major restorations, alterations and/or new construction(s) intended within the property, the buffer zone(s) and/or corridors or other areas, where such developments may affect the Outstanding Universal Value of the property, including authenticity and integrity.

There is no such major restoration, alteration and/or new construction(s) intended within the property, the buffer zone(s) and/or corridors or other areas, where such developments may affect the OUV of the property, including authenticity and integrity.

Potential Future Developments: In accordance with Paragraph 172 of the Operational Guidelines, MPA confirms that there are currently no proposed restorations, alterations, or new construction activities within the property, buffer zones, or adjacent areas that may affect the Sundarbans' OUV, authenticity, or Integrity.

Any future projects will be preceded by a comprehensive Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) and will be reported to UNESCO before implementation, in compliance with the World Heritage Convention procedures.

Mohammad Navid Safiullah
Additional Secretary (Secretary in routine duty)
Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
addsecadmin@moefcc.gov.bd
phone: +880255100433